

Meridian Bank

FFIEC CAT Maturity Pre-Assessment (OCC IT Examination)

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Cybersecurity Assessment Tool pre-assessment + OCC examiner readiness period: FY 2026 Annual Review (Quarter 2)

Meridian Bank FFIEC CAT Maturity Pre-Assessment

> Federal Financial Institutions Examination Council Cybersecurity Assessment Tool maturity assessment across 5 domains and 5 maturity levels. Prepared in advance of the 2026 Q3 OCC IT examination.

1. Scope and Methodology

This pre-assessment evaluates Meridian Bank against the FFIEC Cybersecurity Assessment Tool (CAT) v1.0 maturity model. The assessment covers all five CAT domains (Cyber Risk Management and Oversight, Threat Intelligence and Collaboration, Cybersecurity Controls, External Dependency Management, Cyber Incident Management and Resilience) across five maturity levels (Baseline, Evolving, Intermediate, Advanced, Innovative).

The assessment was conducted through document review (12 policies, 30 vendor records, last IT examination 2025-Q3 MRA closure documentation), interviews with 9 senior leaders (CEO, President/COO, CIO, CISO, CRO, BSA Officer, CCO, Head of TPRM, Head of BCP), and review of the prior MRA remediation workpapers.

Inherent risk profile: High (per Meridian's FFIEC CAT submission and OCC concurrence at 2025-Q3 exam). **Maturity profile target: Intermediate across all five domains** (current state: Intermittent across all five domains).

2. Domain Assessments

2.1 Domain 1: Cyber Risk Management and Oversight

STATEMENT	CURRENT	TARGET	GAP
Cybersecurity strategy documented and board-approved	Intermediate	Advanced	Documentation exists; board metrics need MTTR/MTTC quant
Risk appetite statement includes cyber risk	Intermediate	Advanced	Quantitative tolerances needed
CISO reports to board Risk Committee quarterly	Intermediate	Intermediate	(None)
Independent cyber risk assessment annually	Evolving	Intermediate	Currently internal only; need external assessment
Cybersecurity talent management (recruiting, retention)	Evolving	Intermediate	12 FTE security vs. 3,200 employees is below median

Domain 1 maturity: Intermediate (current), target Advanced. The CISO role is established and reports to the CRO with dotted-line to the board. The gap is mostly in metrics sophistication and independent assessment cadence.

2.2 Domain 2: Threat Intelligence and Collaboration

STATEMENT	CURRENT	TARGET	GAP
Threat intelligence feeds consumed and actioned	Intermediate	Advanced	FS-ISAC membership active but consumption is manual
Collaboration with peers (FS-ISAC, H-ISAC)	Evolving	Intermediate	Limited active participation
Information sharing with law enforcement (FBI, USSS)	Intermediate	Intermediate	(None)
Threat hunting capability	Baseline	Intermediate	No dedicated threat hunting team
Dark web monitoring for credential exposure	Baseline	Intermediate	Not implemented

Domain 2 maturity: Evolving, target Intermediate. The biggest gap is operationalization of threat intelligence beyond consumption.

2.3 Domain 3: Cybersecurity Controls

STATEMENT	CURRENT	TARGET	GAP
Identity and access management (MFA, PAM)	Intermediate	Advanced	PAM for Tier 1 admins implemented; MFA on 89% of systems
Data loss prevention	Evolving	Intermediate	DLP for email only; endpoint and cloud DLP missing
Encryption of data at rest and in transit	Intermediate	Advanced	TLS 1.3 deployed; some legacy systems at TLS 1.2
Vulnerability management	Evolving	Intermediate	Quarterly scans only; need continuous scanning
Penetration testing annual	Intermediate	Intermediate	(None)
Secure software development (if applicable)	Intermediate	Intermediate	(None)
Endpoint detection and response (EDR)	Intermediate	Intermediate	(None)
Network segmentation	Intermediate	Advanced	Flat network in branch tier

Domain 3 maturity: Intermediate, target Advanced. The biggest gaps are continuous vulnerability management and branch network segmentation.

2.4 Domain 4: External Dependency Management

STATEMENT	CURRENT	TARGET	GAP
Third-party risk management program documented	Intermediate	Intermediate	(None)

STATEMENT	CURRENT	TARGET	GAP
Critical vendor inventory maintained	Intermediate	Intermediate	(None)
Vendor cyber risk assessments	Evolving	Intermediate	30 vendors, 60% assessed annually
Vendor SLA monitoring	Intermediate	Intermediate	(None)
Fourth-party (subcontractor) risk visibility	Baseline	Intermediate	Limited visibility into FIS, ACI subcontractors
Vendor exit planning	Evolving	Intermediate	Documented for FIS only

Domain 4 maturity: Evolving, target Intermediate. Fourth-party visibility is the biggest gap; FIS and ACI subprocessor transparency is incomplete.

2.5 Domain 5: Cyber Incident Management and Resilience

STATEMENT	CURRENT	TARGET	GAP
Incident response plan documented	Intermediate	Intermediate	(None)
Tabletop exercises annually	Intermediate	Advanced	Two per year; need cross-functional scenarios
Crisis communication plan	Intermediate	Intermediate	(None)
Recovery time objectives (RTO) tested	Intermediate	Advanced	Annual DR test only; need quarterly
Cyber insurance coverage	Intermediate	Intermediate	\$25M policy; coverage adequacy review needed
Coordination with law enforcement	Intermediate	Intermediate	(None)

Domain 5 maturity: Intermediate, target Advanced. Tabletop cadence and DR testing frequency are the gaps.

3. Mature vs. Inherent Risk Profile

Inherent risk: High (cyber exposure from 2.4M customers, 30 critical vendors, \$50.2B in custody assets, correspondent banking relationships).

Maturity profile: Intermittent across all five domains (current state per 2025-Q3 exam).

Target maturity: Intermediate across all five domains (annual board Risk Committee target).

Maturity gap analysis:

DOMAIN	CURRENT	TARGET	GAP TO CLOSE
1. Risk Management and Oversight	Intermediate	Advanced	Independent assessment, metrics sophistication
2. Threat Intelligence and Collaboration	Evolving	Intermediate	Threat hunting, FS-ISAC operationalization
3. Cybersecurity Controls	Intermediate	Advanced	Continuous vuln mgmt, branch segmentation

DOMAIN	CURRENT	TARGET	GAP TO CLOSE
4. External Dependency Management	Evolving	Intermediate	Fourth-party visibility, vendor assessment coverage
5. Cyber Incident Management and Resilience	Intermediate	Advanced	Tabletop cadence, DR test frequency

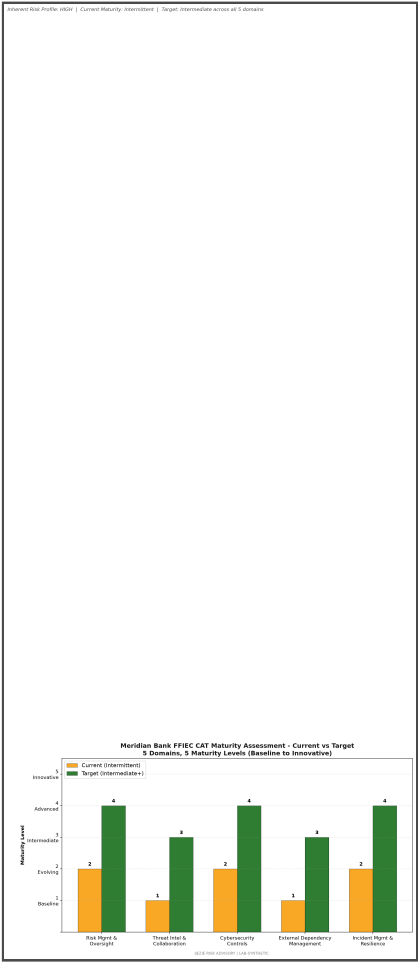


Figure 1: Meridian Bank FFIEC CAT Maturity Assessment - Current vs Target State

4. Recommendations

- 1. **Independent cyber risk assessment (Domain 1):** Engage a Big 4 firm for annual independent assessment; budget \$250K-\$400K.
- 2. **Threat hunting capability (Domain 2):** Stand up a 3-FTE threat hunting team with \$300K tool budget (Tanium, CrowdStrike, or similar).
- 3. **Continuous vulnerability management (Domain 3):** Implement Tenable.io or Qualys continuous scanning; budget \$200K annually.
- 4. **Branch network segmentation (Domain 3):** Phased rollout over 18 months, \$1.5M capex.
- 5. **Fourth-party risk program (Domain 4):** Contractual right-to-audit clause standardization; annual subprocessor inventory reviews with FIS, ACI, Fiserv.

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6. **Tabletop and DR cadence (Domain 5):** Move from 2x annual tabletop to 4x; add quarterly component-level DR tests.

5. Examiner Readiness

This pre-assessment should be presented to the OCC examiner at the opening meeting of the 2026-Q3 IT examination. The maturity gaps identified are consistent with the MRA-closure documentation from 2026-Q1 and demonstrate proactive risk identification consistent with OCC Heightened Standards guidance.

Estimated examination duration: 6-8 weeks (typical for \$50B asset bank with MRA history). **Estimated remediation timeline to reach target maturity:** 18-24 months.

6. What This Demonstrates

This pre-assessment demonstrates the vCISO discipline of working a regulator's framework backward from the examiner's perspective, not from the auditor's perspective. The FFIEC CAT is voluntary but examiners use it as the primary lens; producing this artifact before the examiner arrives (rather than after they ask) is the difference between a clean exam cycle and an MRA.

7. Review and Update Schedule

- **Quarterly:** Refresh domain maturity assessments with new control evidence
- **Annually:** Full pre-assessment refresh prior to OCC exam (target Q2 of each year)
- **Trigger-based:** Update upon any material change (acquisition, new critical vendor, regulatory change)